



16-Day Cultural and Natural Exploration of North India

Circuit : Amritsar – Jalandhar – Dalhousie – Dharamshala – Manali - Shimla – Chandigarh - Delhi

Details of the Traveler:

Name: Travel Center, UK
Number of travellers: 11 Adults

Dates of Travel:

Arrival: 25 October 2026
Departure: 10 November 2026

OUTLINE ITINERARY (Option 3)

Day 01 (25/10): Arrive Amritsar at 0535 Hrs

Upon arrival in Amritsar, you will be met by our representative and transferred to your hotel for check-in.

Amritsar was founded in 1577 by their fourth Sikh guru, Ram Das, and is home to Sikhism's holiest shrine, the spectacular Golden Temple, one of India's most serene and humbling sights. Alas, the same can't be said for the hyperactive streets surrounding the temple – few places can compete with Amritsar when it comes to congestion, air-pollution and traffic noise.

Late afternoon, visit **Wagah Border for Change of Guard Ceremony**.

Wagah Border is the international border between India and Pakistan. Every day at sunset, thousands of Indians, Pakistanis and foreigners gather to watch the unique tradition of the Changing of the Guard ceremony, flag down ceremony and the synchronized marching of the guards on both sides of the border. This spectacle has been passed by the military on both sides since 1959, and till date the stands overflow with a cheering crowd. The ceremony starts with a blustering parade by the soldiers from both the sides, and ends up in the perfectly coordinated lowering of the two nation flags.



Stay overnight at hotel.

Day 02 (26/10): In Amritsar

Morning proceed for half day sightseeing of Amritsar visiting to **the Golden Temple and Jallianwala Bagh.**



Golden Temple is the holiest abode of Sikhs all over the world. The Golden temple is also known as Harmandir Sahib or Darbar Sahib. This beautiful temple built by the fifth Guru, Guru Arjan Dev, in the 16th Century, is a place of great beauty and sublime peacefulness. The temple has served as a meditation retreat for gurus and wandering mendicants since ancient times. This temple has a unique Sikh architecture. The central part of the temple is situated in the middle of the sarovar and is fully covered with gold. Echoing across the serene lake, the beautiful music of the hymns accompanied by flutes, drums and other stringed instruments spread unique calmness and serenity in the air.

Jallianwalla Bagh is situated in the close proximity of the Golden Temple. It is a site where thousands of innocent Indians were brutally shot dead by British Troops on 13 April, 1919 – the day of Baisakhi Festival. Today, the site houses a memorial of national importance in the memory of those killed during the Jallianwala Bagh Massacre.

Stay overnight at hotel.

Day 03 (27/10): Amritsar to Jalandhar – By Surface (85 Kms / 2.5 Hrs)

After an unhurried breakfast, you will depart from Amritsar and drive towards Jalandhar, a pleasant journey through the fertile plains of Punjab, dotted with mustard fields, villages, and lively roadside scenes. The drive is comfortable and takes approximately two to two and a half hours.

En route, stop at **Kular** and **Bal Kohna**, known for their local Sikh heritage and rural Punjabi life.

Upon arrival in Jalandhar, you will check in to your hotel and have time to relax after the journey. Later in the afternoon, you may visit the revered **Devi Talab Mandir**, an ancient temple dedicated to Goddess Durga and an important pilgrimage site for devotees from across the region. This can be followed by a visit to **Company Bagh**, a serene green park located in the heart of the city, ideal for a gentle walk and some quiet time. The evening is kept free for rest or independent exploration, allowing you to experience the local atmosphere at your own pace.



Stay overnight at hotel.

Day 04 (28/10): In Jalandhar

Today is dedicated to exploring Jalandhar, a city known for its deep cultural roots and modern development. After breakfast, proceed to the **Pushpa Gujral Science City**, an engaging and educational attraction featuring interactive exhibits, science galleries, and an IMAX theatre, making it a fascinating visit for travelers of all ages. Later, you may visit **Rangla Punjab Haveli**, a beautifully recreated Punjabi village setting where traditional architecture, folk music, dance performances, and authentic local cuisine provide a vivid insight into Punjab's vibrant heritage. Alternatively, guests

seeking a lighter experience may choose **Wonderland Theme Park** for recreation and leisure.

Later, visit **St. Mary's Cathedral Church** and drive past local markets showcasing Punjab's vibrant culture. In the afternoon, you may choose to explore **Rama Mandi** or enjoy shopping for traditional Punjabi items and sports goods for which Jalandhar is famous. Return to the hotel by evening.



Stay overnight at hotel.

Day 05 (29/10): Jalandhar to Dalhousie – By Surface (210 Kms / 6-7 Hrs)

After an early breakfast, you will depart Jalandhar for Dalhousie, embarking on a longer yet scenic drive that gradually transitions from the plains of Punjab to the forested hills of Himachal Pradesh. The journey passes through **Pathankot**, after which the road begins to climb, offering refreshing views of pine forests, mountain streams, and cool Himalayan air. Upon arrival in Dalhousie, you will check in to your hotel and take time to rest after the drive. In the evening, enjoy a leisurely walk along, where **Gandhi Chowk and Mall Road** colonial-era architecture, quaint shops, and panoramic views create a charming mountain ambience. The cool climate and peaceful surroundings make for a perfect introduction to this hill station, with the rest of the evening free to relax and unwind.

Stay overnight at hotel.

Day 06 (30/10): In Dalhousie – Excursion to Khajjiar

After breakfast, drive to Khajjiar, popularly known as the “**Mini Switzerland of India**,” surrounded by dense deodar forests. Spend time at the picturesque **Khajjiar meadow and lake**, enjoy a leisurely

nature walk or **optional horse riding**, and, if time permits, visit Kalatop Wildlife Sanctuary. Return to Dalhousie by evening for overnight stay.



Stay overnight at hotel.

Day 07 (31/10): Dalhousie to Dharamshala – By Surface (120 Kms / 4 Hrs)

After breakfast, depart Dalhousie and begin your scenic drive towards Dharamshala, passing through rolling hills, pine forests, and small Himalayan towns en route.

Upon arrival in Dharamshala, transfer to hotel.

Dharamshala, the home of His Highness Dalai Lama is the principal township of the Kangra Valley region is magnificently set to the background of the Dhauldhar Mountains. Also known as the ‘Scotland of India’ Dharamshala is a beautiful place with a gift of nature where the dense pine and deodar forest, cool healthy air, various streams, attractive surroundings and the snowline makes an ideal holiday destination. It was established by the British between 1815 and 1857. The place is full of life yet peaceful and is ideal for meditation.

Evening is at leisure. Stay overnight at hotel.

Day 08 (01/11): In Dharamshala

Morning proceed for full day sightseeing of Dharamshala visiting the **Dalai Lama Temple**,

Bhagsunath Temple, Tibetan Museum, Tibetan Library, Kangra State Museum and Mcleodganj Market.



Thousands of pilgrims come to His Holiness the **Dalai Lama Temple** to seek his blessings. **Namgyal Monastery** is a sacred building enclosing the residence of Dalai Lama, the spiritual leader of Tibetan Government in exile. The complex is constructed in a location near Mcleodganj and is overlooked by the mountain ranges of Dhauladhar.

Bhagsunath Temple is said to be 5100 years old temple dedicated to Lord Shiva with a 30 feet waterfall revered by devotees who throng the temple and admire the idol adorning the temple having great healing powers. Walking is a good experience to enjoy the serene surroundings.

Tibetan Museum is a blend of Tibetan architectural style and modern style of constructions. This modern museum of Dharamshala is located inside the Tsuglagkhang Complex in Mcleodganj. The museum showcases valued collections of historical documents, manuscripts, Thangka images, pottery and many handicraft items signifying the cultural and artistic excellence of Tibetan people.

Tibetan Library is located at Gangchen Kyishong Complex serving as an excellent depository of rich heritage of Tibetan literature and enclosing original Tibetan Manuscripts. The library is a valuable treasure of Tibetan works, cultures and arts and also has an excellent collection of rare photographs and books on the Himalayan region.

Kangra State Museum showcases the artifacts of Tibetan and Buddhist cultures. The gallery consists of miniature paintings of Kangra's rich past, pottery, rare coin memorabilia, sculptures and anthropological materials. You may also sight varied collection of jewellery of various tribes, costumes and wood carvings along with contemporary artworks that adds to the attraction to the museum.

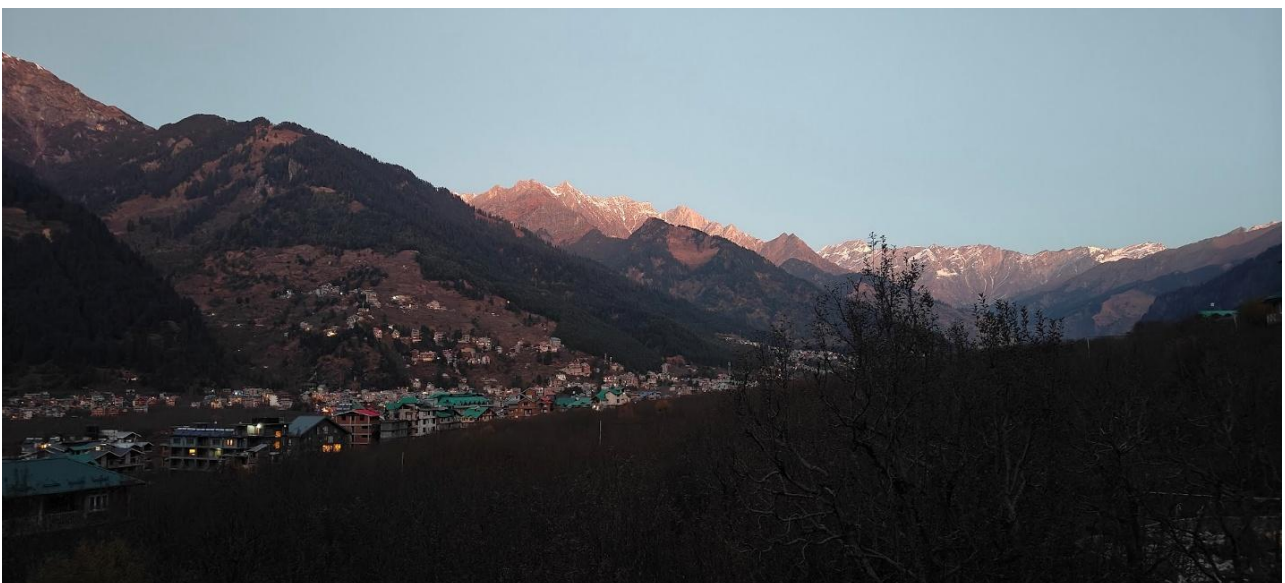
McLeod Ganj Market is famous for Tibetan art and craft items sold in this place like the Tibetan Carpets, votive objects, ponchos, thangkas, chubas, masks, silver and stone jewelery, bottled products, muesli, jackets, statuettes and many other artifacts and handicrafts. The place is considered perfect for souvenirs and handcrafted items.

Stay overnight at hotel.

Day 09 (02/11): Dharamshala to Manali – By surface / 240 Kms / 7-8 hrs

Morning visit the **Norbulingka Institute (Closed on Sundays)** was founded by the Buddhist Saint and the revered Tibetan leader Dalai Lama to preserve and develop Tibetan arts and culture. The institute promotes Tibetan art and culture, Music, dance, wood work, handicrafts and carvings. Losel Doll Museum is another attraction in the institute that showcases 160 dolls made in last 15 years showing the activities and costumes of Tibet.

Later, depart Dharamshala for Manali via **Nagar** to Manali. Nagar was the capital of Kullu Rajas till 1660 A.D. The ancient castle, which has now been converted into a Tourist Bungalow, overlooks the entire Beas valley. There are two old temples near the castle. Nicholas Roerich, the famous Russian painter and philosopher lived at Nagar and his quaint little house has been converted into a small museum.



Manali is situated near the end of the valley on the national highway leading to Leh. The landscape here is breathtaking. One sees well-defined snow-capped peaks, the Beas River with its clear waters meanders through the town. On the other side are deodar and pine trees, tiny fields and fruit orchards.

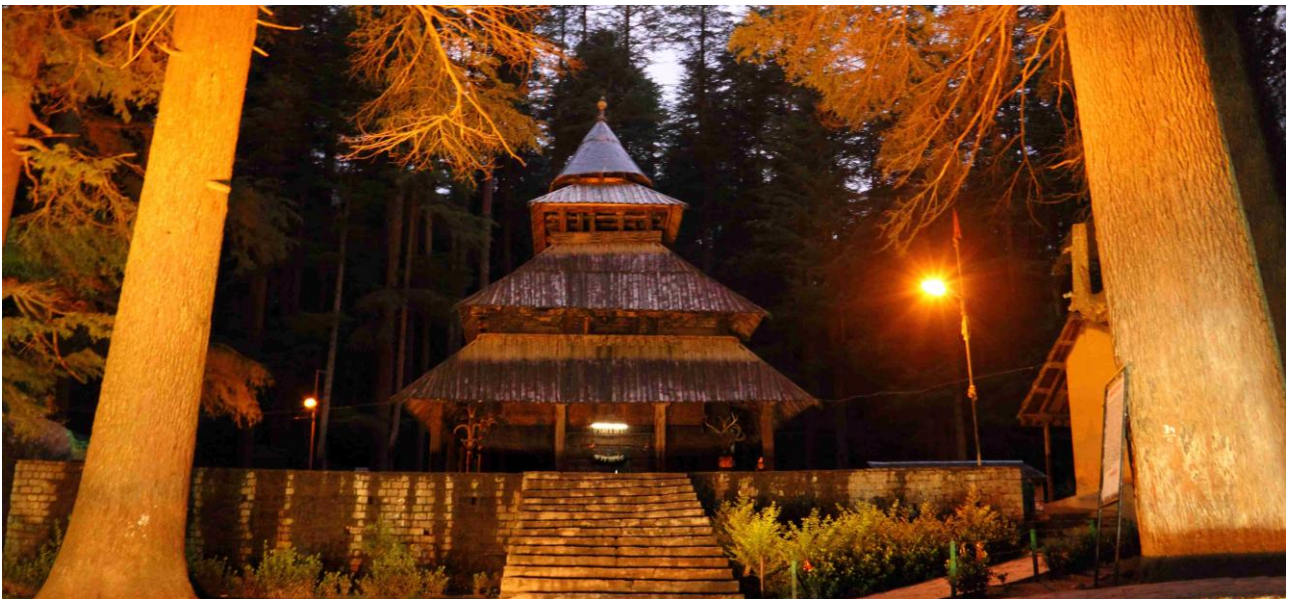
On arrival at Manali check into your hotel. Afternoon is at your disposal to **explore down town**. Manali is famous for apple orchards, its old wooden temples and its folk music and dance.

Note: Presently Naggar castle is closed due to renovation.

Overnight stay at hotel.

Day 10 (03/11): In Manali – Local Sightseeing

Today is free to explore Manali at your own pace. There are many forest tracks, orchards and fields to enjoy. There is also a very colourful Tibetan bazaar where many great bargains can be had. A visit around could include **Old Manali, Hadimba Temple, and Dhungri village**.



Overnight stay at hotel.

Day 11 (04/11): In Manali – Excursion to Rohtang Pass

After an early breakfast, drive from Manali to **Rohtang Pass (approx. 51 km one way, 2–3 hours each way depending on traffic and road conditions)**, ascending through scenic mountain roads with views of glaciers, waterfalls, and snow-capped peaks. En route, pass **Kothi, Gulaba, and Rahala Falls**, with short photo stops. At Rohtang Pass (3,978 m), enjoy panoramic Himalayan views and, if conditions permit, some time for snow activities. Return to Manali by late afternoon or early evening.

Note: Rohtang Pass is subject to weather conditions and requires a permit; it may be closed during

bad weather or peak restrictions.

Overnight stay at hotel.

Day 12 (05/11): Manali to Shimla – By Surface (250 Kms / 8 Hrs)

After an early breakfast, depart Manali for Shimla on one of Himachal Pradesh's longest yet most scenic road journeys.

Shimla is called "Queen of Hill Stations" as it is situated at an altitude of approx. 6500 ft above sea level, and is the capital of the North Indian State of Himachal Pradesh. Shimla was the former official summer capital of the Government of India right up until 1947, when India gained Independence. Shimla was originally a small hill village named after the goddess Shamla Devi, a manifestation of Kali. Discovered by the British in 1819, it became a popular refuge from the heat of the plains of North India. In 1903, a railway line was laid, connecting it to the plains, and thus making it easily accessible.

Rest of the day is at leisure.

Stay overnight at hotel.

Day 13 (06/11): In Shimla

Morning, proceed for full day sightseeing tour of Shimla visiting **Vice Regal Lodge, The Shimla Jakhu Temple, St. Michael's Cathedral and Mall Road.**



Vice Regal Lodge is located at the top of Observatory Hills and was constructed by the British. This brilliant building served as the residence of the Viceroy, Lord Dufferin. It was completed by the year 1888 and it is still well maintained. This Lodge has now been transformed into the famous Institute of Advanced Studies and the six storey building still stands in all its splendor. The lodge has famous gardens and perfectly manicured lawns.

Continue to **Jakhoo Hill**, the highest point in Shimla, offering panoramic views of the town and the surrounding Himalayas, and home to the ancient Hanuman Temple. Later, enjoy a refreshing **forest walk at Annandale**, a scenic, pine-covered valley known for its natural beauty and tranquility. In the evening, spend your time at leisure—**café-hopping** along the Mall Road or indulging in **local market shopping**, soaking in the charm of Shimla's lively atmosphere.

Stay overnight at hotel.

Day 14 (07/11): **Shimla to Kalka – By Toy train (SML KLK EXP. Dep: 1055 Hrs / Arr: 16155 Hrs)**
– to Chandigarh – By Surface (28 Kms / 45 Mins)

Morning in time transfer to Shimla railways station to board your **toy train ride** to Kalka.

This iconic narrow-gauge toy train journey covers a distance of approximately **96 km** and takes around **5 to 5.5 hours**, arriving at Kalka at **16:15 hrs**. Recognized as a **UNESCO World Heritage experience**, the train winds its way through spectacular mountain scenery, passing through numerous tunnels, bridges, pine forests, and charming hill stations along the route. The leisurely pace of the journey offers uninterrupted views of the Shivalik ranges and surrounding valleys, making it one of the most memorable highlights of the trip.

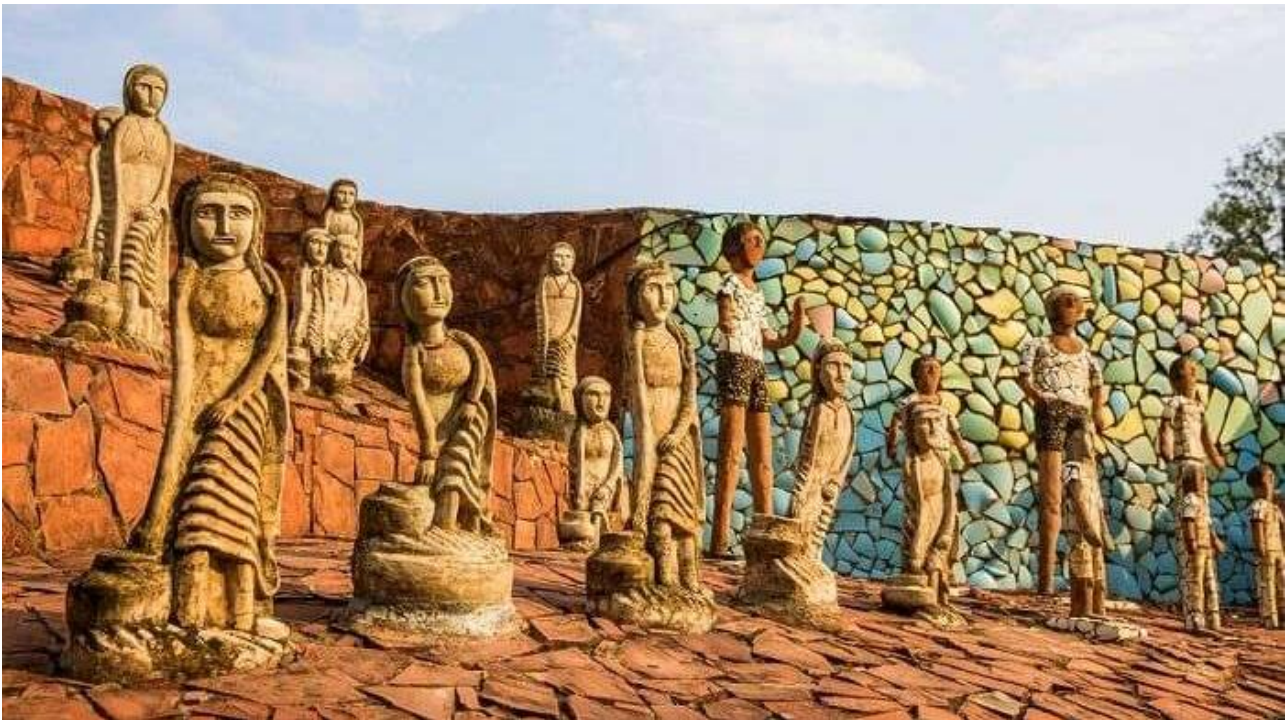


Upon arrival in Kalka, you will be met by our representative and transferred to your hotel in Chandigarh.

Stay overnight at hotel.

Day 15 (08/11): **Chandigarh to Delhi – By Flight (Dep: 1800 Hrs / Arr: 1855 Hrs)**

Morning, proceed for a full-day sightseeing tour of Chandigarh, beginning with a visit to the **Rock Garden**, Nek Chand's extraordinary creation of sculptures made from recycled materials. Continue to the tranquil **Sukhna Lake**, where you can enjoy a leisurely stroll or an optional boat ride on its serene waters. After lunch, explore the Zakir Hussain **Rose Garden**, Asia's largest, renowned for its vast collection of over 1,600 varieties of roses and other ornamental plants.



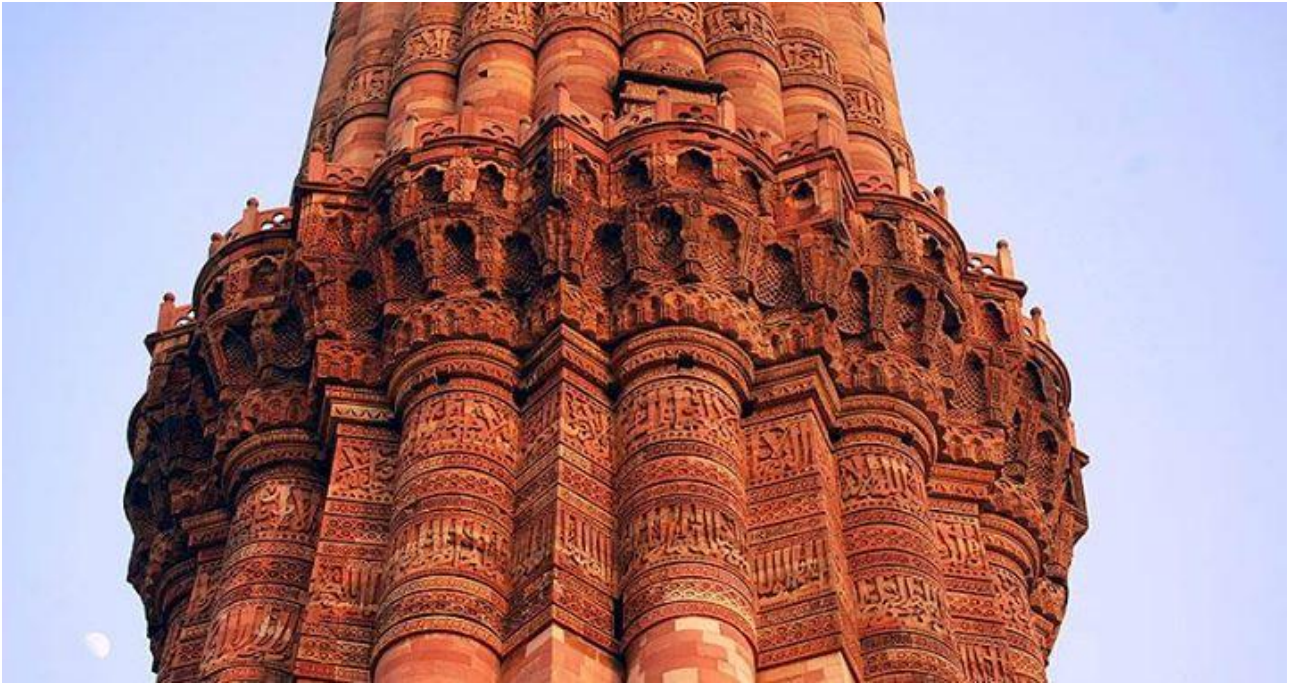
Later, in time transfer to Chandigarh airport to board your flight to Delhi. On your arrival in Delhi, you will be met by our representative and transferred to your hotel.

Stay overnight at hotel.

Day 16 (09/11): **Depart Delhi**

After Breakfast, proceed for a city tour of New Delhi. You will be visiting **Qutub Minar, Humayun Tomb and Lodhi Garden**.

Qutab Minar is amongst the tallest and the most famous monuments in the world. This beautiful minaret is 234 feet high and is regarded as the tallest individual tower in the world. The Qutab Minar is one of the many masterpieces that depicted the sheer brilliance of the Mughal architects. Qutbu'd-Din Aibak laid the foundation of Minar in AD 1199 for the use of the mu'azzin (crier) to give calls for prayer and raised the first storey, to which were added three more storeys by his successor and son-in-law, Shamsu'd-Din Iltutmish (AD 1211-36).



Later visit the **Humayun's Tomb**. Humayun's the second Mughal Emperor of India died in 1556, and his widow Hamida Banu Begam, also known as Haji Begam, commenced the construction of his tomb in 1569, fourteen years after his death. Humayun's Tomb is the first distinct example of proper Mughal style, which was inspired by Persian architecture.

Later in time transfer to New Delhi International airport to board your flight back home / onward journey.

END OF SERVICES

Tour Cost

NO OF PERSONS	TOUR COST
For 08 paying persons sharing 04 Double / Twin Rooms	GBP 1125 per person
For 03 paying persons sharing 01 Triple Room	GBP 1065 per person

Hotels Envisaged

(Accommodation will be provided in the mentioned hotels or Similar)

City	Hotel Name	No. Of Nights	Room Category
Amritsar	Ranjit Svaasa	02 Nights	Standard Room
Jalandhar	Sarovar Portico	02 Nights	Standard Room
Dalhousie	Grand View Dalhousie	02 Nights	Standard Room
Dharamsala	Amritara Surya	02 Nights	Standard Room
Manali	Anantmaya Resort	03 Nights	Standard Room
Shimla	Snow Valley Resort	02 Nights	Valley Room
Chandigarh	Country inn & Suites by Radisson	02 Nights	Standard Room
Delhi	Zone Connect by the Park	01 Night	Standard Room
TOTAL		16 Nights	

Above Cost Includes:

- Accommodation at all cities in the mentioned hotels as per the above list in 03 Triple & 01 Dbl/Twin sharing rooms on CP basis (Room + Breakfast)
- Arrival/Departure transfers in Himachal & Punjab as per the itinerary using 04 AC Toyota Innova Cars/Jeeps (3 Pax in 01 Jeep)
- All drives and sightseeing in Himachal & Punjab as per the itinerary using 04 AC Toyota Innova Cars/Jeeps (3 Pax in 01 Jeep)
- Arrival/Departure transfers in Delhi using 01 Mini Bus
- Assistance on arrival and departure transfers
- Toy train ride from Shimla to Kalka in AC Chair Car (FC class) as per the itinerary
- One time entrance fees to monuments, national parks and museums as per the program only
- One bottle of Mineral water per day
- Services of an accompanied English-speaking escort throughout the trip

- All applicable government taxes

Above Cost Does Not Includes:

- International airfare and airport taxes
- Any personal, medical and evacuation insurance
- Personal expenses like table drinks, mineral water, tips, phone calls etc.
- Lunches and dinners
- Tips for the driver, guide, in restaurants, porters at airports, hotel bellboys, and for those who take care of shoes outside sacred places and Muslim monuments, as in India you have to take off your shoes in all temples, in some you can wear socks.
- Visa for India. You can apply for an e-Tourist Visa online for short trips to India. Its maximum duration will be 30 days.
- Domestic airfare within India
- Anything not specified in the section "Price Includes"

Note:

If there is any unprecedented hike in the cost of transport (including fuel surcharge) or accommodation it will also affect the cost.

We shall not be responsible for any change in the itinerary due to landslides, flight cancellations, weather conditions or any foreseen circumstances. The additional cost incurred will be in addition to the cost.

Rates are valid for travel between 1st of October 2026 till 31st March 2027 (Except during the period from 20th of December 2026 till 05th of January 2027)